

Mariko Bronson

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EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Barbara | Santa Barbara, CA – Completed 2025, Conferred 2026

B.S. Environmental Studies

Relevant Coursework: Soil Science and Analysis, Statistics and Data Science, Restoration Skills, Sustainable Innovation

University of Queensland | Brisbane, Australia – Fall Quarter 2025

Education Abroad Program | Marine Biology and Terrestrial Ecology

Relevant Experience: Research Skills, Scientific Writing, In-Field Data Collection and Analysis, RStudio

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE AT UCSB

LABWORK

Research Assistant | Partnership for Interdisciplinary Studies of Coastal Oceans (PISCO) 04/2022 - 12/2024

- Identified and logged larval marine invertebrate species via microscopy three times weekly
- Extracted, labeled, preserved, and archived larvae in ethanol

Research Assistant | Tejon Ranch Enclosure Experiment - Young Lab 07/2024 - 08/2025

- Quantified mass loss in plant matter by cleaning, sorting, and weighing samples
- Labeled, organized, and databased samples

FIELDWORK

Research Assistant | Herptile Responses to Prescribed Burning - Young Lab 09/2024 - 08/2025

- Monitored 47 herptile boards in Sedgwick Reserve to assess impacts of controlled burns on wildlife populations
- Collected field data on temperature, humidity, and species presence of herptiles and rodents

Research Assistant | Serpentine Detection with Remote Sensing - Anderegg Lab 04/2025 - 05/2025

- Collected, labeled, and organized soil samples from Sedgwick Reserve for remote sensing research

Research Assistant | Initiative to Increase Fire Resilience in California - VEG Lab 07/2025 - 08/2025

- Identified and harvested seeds of fire-resistant plant species for seed banking

WORK EXPERIENCE

Campus Organizer | CALPIRG 09/2023 - 08/2025

- Tabled on campus to encourage student participation in environmental campaigns
- Collected environmental petition signatures; maintained volunteer engagement via phonebanking
- Assisted in facilitating fundraising and awareness-raising events

Direct Support Professional | Creative Options Plus. Inc 02/2026 - present

- Provided direct care to adults with autism spectrum disorder at a structured day program
- Planned individualized daily activities tailored to each client's abilities with a focus on socialization and independence
- Monitored safety and behavior with gentle guidance and de-escalation techniques

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

Patient Care Volunteer (Blue Jackets Program) | Torrance Memorial Medical Center 2016 - 2020

- Facilitated activities for children at fundraising events
- Assembled care packages and handmade blankets for patients
- Provided patient escort and non-medical assistance; delivered gifts and lab samples

Volunteer | Harbor Animal Shelter 2018 - 2020

- Provided basic care and individualized socialization to dogs and cats
- Advised potential adopters on animal compatibility and care requirements

Volunteer | Palos Verdes Land Conservancy 2018 - 2020

- Staffed booths selling native plants and seeds for fundraising; promoted free local conservation events
- Assisted in community event coordination such as beach clean-ups and nature hikes

SKILLS, TRAINING & INTERESTS

Skills: Microsoft Office Suite, Google Workspace, R Studio, Canva; strong written and verbal communication, detail-oriented

Training: Field Futures Training, Lab safety training, CALPIRG leadership and storytelling training

Interests: Ecology • Soil Science • Sustainable Development & Innovation • Carbon Management • Energy Systems
Entomology • Urban Planning